FIGHTERBASE

Primal

Diet guide

Like paleo, with some dairy.



Prepared 10 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Primal**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Primal?

A close cousin of paleo that allows full-fat dairy and is a bit more relaxed about some foods.

Where it comes from

Mark Sisson's 'Primal Blueprint' (2009) is a more flexible cousin of paleo. It keeps the whole-food, no-grain, no-sugar approach but allows quality dairy for those who tolerate it, and puts equal weight on sleep, movement and sunshine.

The main ideas

1. Eat meat, fish, eggs, vegetables, fruit, nuts and seeds.
2. Quality dairy (full-fat, grass-fed, fermented) is allowed if it suits you.
3. Avoid grains, sugar, processed food, seed oils and most legumes.
4. Dark chocolate and a little red wine are fine in moderation (the '80/20' idea).
5. Lifestyle counts too: sleep, walking, play and sun.

Who it suits

- People who like paleo but want cheese and yoghurt back
- People who want a whole-food plan with some flexibility
- People who like the 80/20 idea

Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:

- You have a medical condition, allergy or intolerance
- You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18
- You have ever had an eating disorder
- You are cutting weight for a fight

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Add starchy carbs (sweet potato, squash, fruit, some rice if you allow it) around hard sessions.
- Dairy helps with protein and calcium, which makes primal easier for athletes than strict paleo.
- Eat enough; whole foods are filling and calories can fall short.
- Full-fat Greek yoghurt with fruit is a good recovery snack.

> Root veg and fruit for carbs, Greek yoghurt or eggs for recovery.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Calcium
bones
Where: hard cheese, yoghurt, sardines, greens

Carbohydrate
session fuel
Where: sweet potato, fruit, squash, honey

Protein
repair
Where: meat, fish, eggs, yoghurt

Omega-3
recovery and joints
Where: oily fish, walnuts, flax

Common mistakes

- Under-eating carbs for training volume
- Treating 'primal' treats as everyday food
- Too much dairy for those who do not tolerate it
- Ignoring sleep, which Primal puts at the centre

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Sugar and starch hide as: maltodextrin, glucose syrup, wheat starch, dextrose
- Seed oils: sunflower, rapeseed (canola), soybean, corn oil
- Check flavoured yoghurts and sauces for added sugar

Eating out

- Choose grilled meat or fish and vegetables or salad.
- Cheese and cream are fine; skip bread and sugar.
- Ask for olive oil or butter.
- Dark chocolate or berries and cream for dessert.

Easy swaps

Bread	→	Lettuce wrap or cheese crisps
Pasta	→	Courgetti
Rice	→	Cauliflower rice
Sweets	→	Dark chocolate (85%+)
Vegetable oil	→	Olive oil, butter, ghee, avocado oil

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Eggs, cheese, fruit	Chicken salad with feta	Salmon, sweet potato, greens
Tue	Greek yoghurt, berries, nuts	Tuna and avocado	Steak, mushrooms, salad
Wed	Omelette with cheese	Soup and a boiled egg	Chicken thighs, roast vegetables
Thu	Sausages, eggs	Prawn and avocado salad	Lamb, squash, green beans
Fri	Berries and cream	Leftover lamb, salad	Fish, vegetables, butter
Sat	Bacon, eggs, tomato	Cheese and cold meat plate	Beef burger, no bun, sweet potato fries
Sun	Full breakfast, no toast	Roast leftovers	Roast pork, vegetables, apple sauce

Snacks

Cheese · Nuts · Boiled eggs · Fruit · Full-fat yoghurt · Dark chocolate · Jerky

Shopping list

Meat, fish, eggs · Hard cheese, full-fat yoghurt, butter · Vegetables and fruit · Nuts and seeds · Olive oil, avocado · Dark chocolate 85%+

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

What is the difference from paleo?

Primal allows good-quality dairy and is more relaxed about treats.

Do I have to eat 100% primal?

No. The 80/20 idea means mostly primal, with some room for life.

Is it good for training?

It can be, with enough starchy carbs.

Further reading

Mark Sisson, The Primal Blueprint; British Dietetic Association.



For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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